



VIKRAM SHARMA/www.indiatodayimages.com

"JIHADI TERRORISM CAN BE COUNTERED SUCCESSFULLY IF YOU ARE ABLE TO SHARE INTELLIGENCE AND ACT IN REAL TIME."

P. CHIDAMBARAM

rorist attacks though 2010 began with a blot on our record. Pune was indeed a blot. I hope we have learnt our lessons from Pune too. Maoism is an even graver threat today. The Naxalites have a presence in over 200 districts and are capable of striking in 83 districts. They virtually dominate 34 districts. They have declared a war on Indian state. The Government doesn't use words like enemy or war. The Maoists use them routinely. A recent document that we were able to unearth in January 2010 reads: "Low intensity conflict is the latest counter-insurgency doctrine of the imperialist (meaning the Indian Government). Defeat low intensity conflict through protracted people's war." The document goes on to say that the Maoist must evolve a revolutionary strategy to defeat the enemy. It lays emphasis on political, organisational and military preparedness for the outfit. It spells out a number of steps with the aim of capturing power

through an armed liberation struggle. What saddens me is that civil society groups, NGOs, human rights activists do not understand the character of the Maoists. They believe, rather naively, that the Maoists are friends of the poor and their goal is the emancipation and the development of the poor. Nothing can be further from the truth. The Maoists are anti-development; they do not want the poor to be emancipated or to become economically free. Why do they demolish school buildings, why do they blow up railway tracks that are laid in those areas, why do they plant landmines on roads that are constructed in those areas? Why do they drive away doctors and teachers who are sent to rural India? Their goal is armed liberation struggle, their sole objective is the seizure of power, and for that they wish to create what are called liberated zones. They have begun this in areas where the tribals live because they are the poorest; they are the most